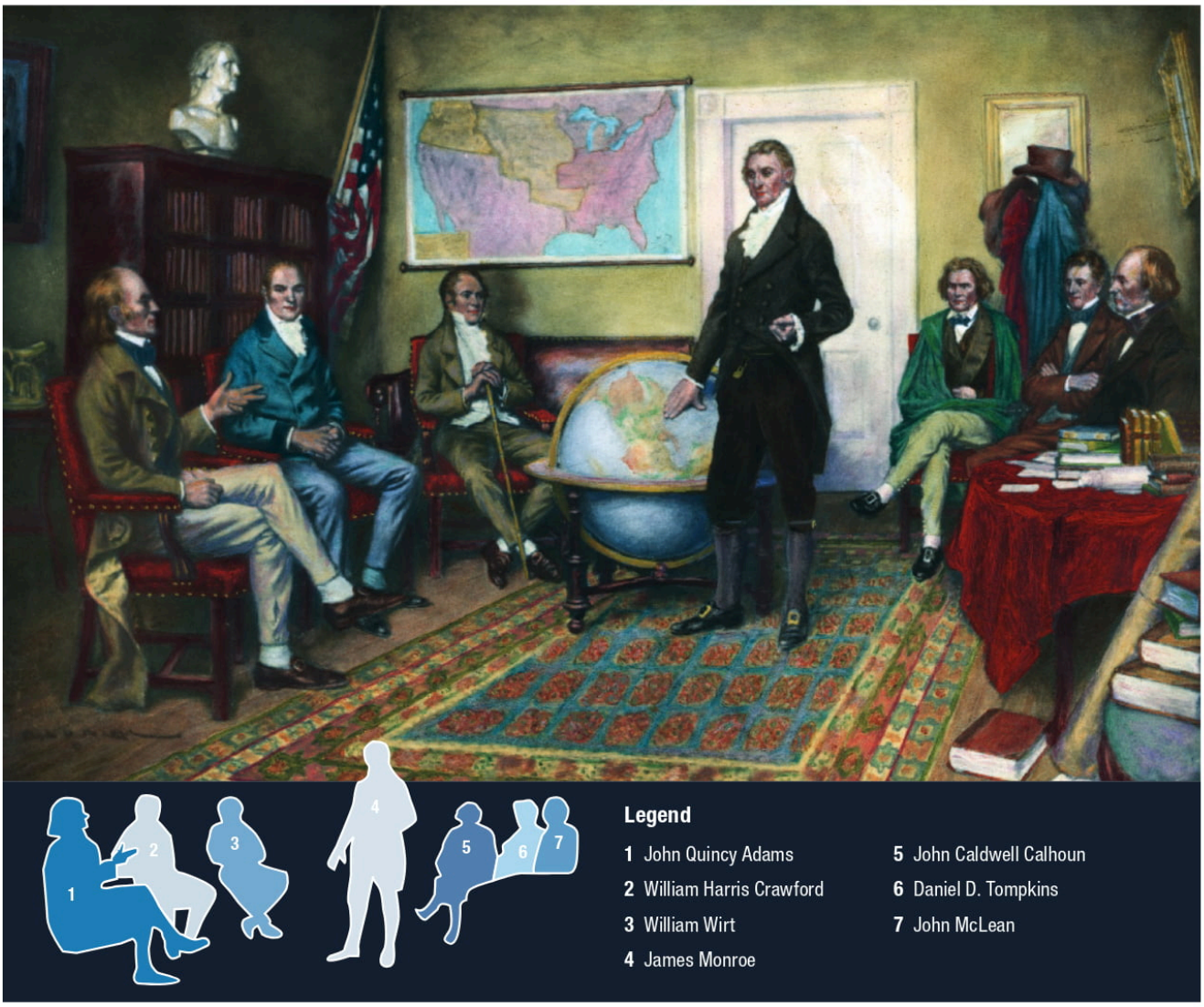
DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

3.3 The Monroe Doctrine

In the early 19th century, the United States began to position itself as a world power. One part of that new role for the young country, according to President James Monroe, was protecting countries in Central and South America from future interference from European monarchies. The Monroe Doctrine, as his 1823 statement came to be known, would shape U.S. foreign policy for more than a century.

On December 2, 1823, President Monroe delivered his seventh annual message to Congress, or what we know today as a State of the Union address. Monroe touched on many topics, but most significantly, he introduced a new policy toward Europe and the Western Hemisphere.

CRITICAL VIEWING In this 1912 painting by Clyde DeLand, titled *Birth of the Monroe Doctrine*, President Monroe is outlining his new policy to his cabinet in preparation for his address. Notice the map and the globe. What do you think their significance is?



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DOCUMENT ONE

Primary Source: Speech
from War Message to Congress,
by James Madison, June 1, 1812

The U.S. Navy was young compared to Great Britain's. While navigating Atlantic waters, American sailors had to deal with frequent interference from Great Britain. President Madison delivered this speech as a warning that further activity would initiate an open conflict.

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE How does Madison's summary of British actions make a case for retaliation?

> British cruisers have been in the practice also of violating the rights and the peace of our coasts. They hover over and harass our entering and departing commerce. When called on, nevertheless, by the United States to punish the greater offenses committed by her [Britain's] own vessels, her government has bestowed on their commanders additional marks of honor and confidence.

DOCUMENT TWO

Primary Source: Speech
from Seventh Annual Message to Congress,
by James Monroe, December 2, 1823

In this speech, President Monroe declared that from that point on, European monarchies were not allowed to interfere in Central and South America. At the same time, he promised that the United States would stay out of European affairs.

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE How does Monroe's speech communicate a strategy for both peacetime and military action, if provoked?

> In the wars of the European powers in matters relating to themselves we have never taken any part, nor does it comport with our policy to do so. It is only when our rights are invaded or seriously menaced that we resent injuries or make preparation for our defense. With the movements in this hemisphere we are of necessity more immediately connected, and by causes which must be obvious to all enlightened and impartial [unbiased] observers.

DOCUMENT THREE

Primary Source: Essay
from "The Monroe Doctrine and Spanish America,"
by Juan Bautista Alberdi, c. 1850

Juan Bautista Alberdi, a political thinker from Argentina, expressed concern that Monroe's new policy would threaten the political and economic independence of the countries it promised to protect.

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE How does Alberdi's opinion of the Monroe Doctrine differ from Monroe's description of his new policy?

> The doctrine attributed to Monroe is a contradiction, the daughter of egoism [self-centeredness]. Even though the United States owes everything to Europe, it wants to isolate America from Europe, from any influence that does not emanate [originate] from the United States, which will make the United States the only custom house [official port] for the civilization of transatlantic origin.

SYNTHESIZE & WRITE

1. **REVIEW** Review what you have learned about the position of the United States as a rising world power in the early 1800s.
2. **RECALL** On your own paper, write down the main ideas expressed in the excerpts from Madison's and Monroe's speeches and Alberdi's essay.
3. **CONSTRUCT** Construct a topic sentence that supports or opposes this statement: In the early 1800s, the United States established itself as a world power through a policy of protection and European nonintervention in the Americas.
4. **WRITE** Write a paragraph that presents an argument for or against the statement in Step 3 using evidence from the documents.

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